

MATH 230 SECTION SYLLABUS – FALL 2026
SECTIONS 005/009

Instructor: Sean Pooley
Email: seanpooley@psu.edu
Office: 012 McAllister
Office Hours: Thursday 10:00–11:00 AM
Class Details: Section 005 / 9:05–9:55 AM MWThF in Elec Eng West 203 MWF and Willard Bldg 060 Th
Section 009 / 12:20–1:10 PM MWThF in Earth and Eng Sciences 119

This section syllabus is an abbreviated version of the **Official MATH 230 Department Syllabus for Academic Year 2026–2027**. Consult the department syllabus for the full and complete set of course policies.

Course Description

Three-dimensional analytic geometry; vectors in space; partial differentiation; double and triple integrals; integral vector calculus. Students who have passed either MATH 231 or MATH 232 may not schedule MATH 230 or MATH 230H for credit.

Enforced Prerequisite

Enforced Prerequisite at Enrollment: MATH 141 or MATH 141B or MATH 141E or MATH 141G or MATH 141H.

Required Materials

Calculus: Early Transcendentals by William Briggs, Lyle Cochran, Bernard Gillett, and Eric Schulz, 3rd ed, along with access to Pearson MyLab Math. This means you will need to purchase the online system that accompanies the textbook. You do not need a hard copy of the textbook as the eText comes with purchase of Pearson MyLab. You should check first if you have a still-active version of Pearson MyLab from when you took MATH 140/141 as we typically instruct you to purchase the multiple-semester access. There are some options for purchasing access:

- 18-Week Access: approximately \$85
- 24-Month Access: approximately \$145

Pearson MyLab Instructions

Students should register their Pearson MyLab account using their PSU email address with the same name that is in LionPATH and Canvas. The easiest way to sign up for MyLab is by accessing Pearson from within Canvas.

Class Attendance and Absence

Regular class attendance does correlate with positive learning outcomes. Instructors may decide to implement activities requiring student attendance in order to earn credit. Students who are unable to attend class or complete graded assignments for more than one week at a time will be required to present documentation to verify their significant, prolonged illness. Additionally, if a student requests makeups more than two times for missed assignments, the instructor has the right to deny such requests unless a student has a University-approved reason and/or can provide the proper documentation justifying the absence and, consequently, the missed assignment.

Email Policy

The mathematics department has guidelines in place so that emails from students must receive a reply within 48 hours, excluding weekends and holidays. Emails sent on Friday may not receive a reply until the following week. In the case that I happen to not reply promptly, I ask that you wait no longer than 48 hours before sending a follow-up email. Generally, I do not respond to emails as much in the evening (after 6 PM), and so a response may not come until the following day. Homework questions generally are difficult to answer in great detail via email. To this end, I ask that you attend office hours if you have extensive homework questions.

Calculator Policy

A calculator, online problem solver, downloadable app, etc. is an excellent tool for crunching numbers – especially when working real-world examples with messy constants – as well as a useful study resource. If you do not have a scientific calculator, websites such as GeoGebra and Wolfram Alpha are an excellent resource for computations. Note, however, that these tools are not needed to understand and apply the concepts of the course to examples with simple coefficients (all arithmetic will be simple enough to do by hand.)

No form of calculators or electronic problem solver will be permitted on any of the quizzes or exams for this course unless otherwise specified by your instructor. Their use is a violation of Penn State's Academic Integrity Policy. An Academic Integrity Report will be filed for any unwarranted use of such a device.

Tutors and Penn State Learning

Free mathematics tutoring is available at Penn State Learning. You can find information about their online and in-person options at the following site: pennstatelearning.psu.edu/tutoring/mathematics

Office Hours

Office hours are a useful resource in any course. If you have questions about course content or progress in the course, please do not hesitate to attend office hours. Office hours are **not**, however, a time and place for instructors to re-lecture content. If you miss class, it is your responsibility to get notes from a classmate. Come prepared to office hours with questions that you may have. Additionally, office hours are time to seek clarification, but they are not a time to simply attend and get answers. Instructors do not have an obligation to give you answers to homework questions, but rather, they have an obligation to elaborate on concepts and help you to better understand the material.

Online Homework

Pearson MyLab homework will be **due each week on Tuesdays at 11:59 PM**. Please note that if you do not begin the Pearson MyLab HW, the system will not let you into the assignment to see it after the due date has passed. There will be only one dropped homework assignment from Pearson MyLab, so it is important that you work to complete them all. If you miss a Pearson MyLab due date, you can submit it late, but with a 10% penalty each day on problems completed after the due date.

Written Homework

Written homework will generally be **due each week on Thursdays at 11:59 PM**, with the exception of exam weeks (see course schedule). **No assignments will be accepted after the due date.** Written homework is to be uploaded to Gradescope; please see Canvas for information on how to upload homework PDF files. During the submission process, you will need to specify which problems are present on which pages (including all pages which have work, not just the first page); failure to do so will result in a zero on those problems. No written homework assignments are dropped. There will be one additional homework assignment at the end of the term that will be “optional” and can be used to replace your lowest homework grade of the term. There are no extensions on Written Homework. Also, when submitting to Gradescope, pages must be properly matched to the questions on the assignment, otherwise the assignment will receive a zero.

Learning Assistant Problem Sessions (LAPS)

We have Mathematics Learning Assistants (LAs) assigned to help us in MATH 230. Each week, there will be a series of evening problem sessions scheduled in classrooms on campus that you can attend to get help and additional practice. Each evening session will focus on the content during the previous and/or current week of the term.

Learning Assistant Problem Sessions (LAPS) Attendance Incentive

As an incentive for attending LA evening sessions, you will be able to have up to three of your lowest quiz or worksheet scores replaced by attending and meeting the required number for each of the time periods listed below. **You can attend up to two sessions per week that will count towards the incentive.** Please note that to earn credit, you must attend the sessions for an extended period of time. In addition, you **MUST** work on the worksheets provided. This is not a time to work on homework or in-class work. The Learning Assistants can help clarify concepts but they **DO NOT** give answers. **If you are not working on the designated materials, you will not receive credit for the session.**

- Participate in **6 evening sessions** during weeks 2–8 = One Perfect Score Replacement
- Participate in **5 evening sessions** during weeks 9–15 = Second Perfect Score Replacement
- Participate in a **combined 12 LA sessions across the entire term** = Another Perfect Score Replacement

To properly receive credit for LA sessions, you must complete the attendance form. If an attendance, for whatever reason, does not get counted, the student will be asked to produce the survey confirmations as proof of attendance. Otherwise, the recorded attendance count given by the LA Program will be the official record.

Quizzes

There will be regular quizzes given during class every week (except in the first week and on exam weeks). If you are going to miss a class when there is a quiz and have a valid school-approved excuse for the absence, you must notify me of the absence and the excuse by email **before** the scheduled meeting time of the class to be allowed to make up the quiz at a later time.

Exams

EXAM	DATE	TIME
Exam 1	9/24 (Th)	6:15–7:30 PM
Exam 2	10/21 (W)	6:15–7:30 PM
Exam 3	11/18 (W)	6:15–7:30 PM
Comprehensive Final Exam	TBA	TBA

Rooms for examinations will be announced by your instructor at a later date and will be able to be found on the math department website. Be sure to bring your physical ID, several pencils, and an eraser to all exams.

Makeup Exams

Students who miss or cannot take a midterm examination due to a valid and documented reason, such as illness, may be allowed to take the corresponding makeup examination. The scheduled makeup exam dates are listed below.

MU EXAM	DATE	TIME
MU Exam 1	9/28 (M)	6:15–7:30 PM
MU Exam 2	10/22 (Th)	6:15–7:30 PM
MU Exam 3	11/19 (Th)	6:15–7:30 PM

General Policy on Makeups

See the department syllabus for full policy and procedures on makeups. In general, a university-approved absence is required to take a makeup of any kind (quiz, exam, etc.).

Policy on Reviewing Exams and Quizzes

Questions regarding the grading of exams or missing exam grades should be directed to me as soon as possible. Students and instructors will have until the next exam takes place to review their exam or report a missing grade. Students will have one week from the date of the final exam to contact me regarding questions about the final exam or a missing final exam grade. Final exams are not released. If a student wishes to review their work on the final exam, they must make an appointment with me for the following academic term. This policy also applies to quizzes – any concerns regarding quizzes and/or quiz grading need to be addressed prior to the next quiz.

Final Examination

The final examination may be scheduled on any day during the final examination period, December 14–18, 2026. Students may access their final exam schedules through LionPATH in September. Notification of conflicts is given on the student's final exam schedule. **It is the student's responsibility to apply for any conflict final exams during this time period.** See department syllabus for full policies and procedures.

Grades and Grading Policy

The final grade for the course will be determined according to the following distribution:

Pearson MyLab Homework	12.5%
Written Homework	12.5%
Quizzes	15%
Exams 1–3	35%
Final Exam	25%
Total	100%

Letter Grades

Letter grades for this course are set according to the following cutoffs:

Letter Grade	Score Range
A	92.50%–100%
A-	89.50%–92.49%
B+	86.50%–89.49%
B	82.50%–86.49%
B-	79.50%–82.49%
C+	76.50%–79.49%
C	69.50%–76.49%
D	59.50%–69.49%
F	≤59.49%

Academic Integrity

According to Penn State policy G-9: Academic Integrity, an academic integrity violation is “an intentional, unintentional, or attempted violation of course or assessment policies to gain an academic advantage or to advantage or disadvantage another student academically.” Unless your instructor tells you otherwise, you must complete all course work entirely on your own, using only sources that have been permitted by your instructor, and may not assist other students with papers, quizzes, exams, or other assessments. If your instructor allows you to use ideas, images, or word phrases created by another person (e.g., from Course Hero or Chegg) or by generative technology, such as ChatGPT, you must identify their source. You may not submit false or fabricated information, use the same academic work for credit in multiple courses, or share instructional content. Students with questions about academic integrity should ask their instructor before submitting work. Students facing allegations of academic misconduct may not drop/withdraw from the affected course unless they are cleared of wrongdoing (see G-9: Academic Integrity). Attempted drops will be prevented or reversed, and students will be expected to complete course work and meet course deadlines. Students who are found responsible for academic integrity violations face academic outcomes, which can be severe, and put themselves at jeopardy for other outcomes which may include ineligibility for Dean’s List, pass/fail elections, and grade forgiveness. Students may also face consequences from their home/major program and/or The Schreyer Honors College.

When searching for help with your course, your instructor will always be the best resource for advice. The University is aware of fraudulent companies and scammers who prey on a student’s desire for assistance with coursework. A student who hires someone to do work on their behalf demonstrates a clear example of a violation of academic integrity highlighted above. Sharing login credentials with others is also in violation of Penn State Policy AD95 and may be subject to additional disciplinary action. Furthermore, a fraudulent company and/or scammer may extort the student by threats to communicate the student’s arrangement with the University. If you find yourself in such a situation, it is best to contact your instructor immediately. Link to Academic Integrity Policy: [49-20 Academic Integrity](#)

Disability and Accommodations

If you have accommodations, please be sure to **contact me as soon as possible with details of your accommodation**. Additionally, accommodations letters must be emailed to the Mathematics Department Exam Coordinator, Kyrsten Murphy (kml5346@psu.edu). Any student with a documented disability should contact me as soon as possible so that we can discuss arrangements to fit your needs. For more information, please see the Penn State Educational Equity site: [Penn State Educational Equity](#)

Code of Mutual Respect and Cooperation

The Eberly College of Science Code of Mutual Respect and Cooperation pertains to all members of the college community; faculty, staff, and students. The Code of Mutual Respect and Cooperation was developed to embody the values that we hope our faculty, staff, and students possess, consistent with the aspirational goals expressed in the Penn State Principles. The University is strongly committed to freedom of expression, and consequently, the Code does not constitute University or College policy, and is not intended to interfere in any way with an individual’s academic or personal freedoms. We hope, however, that individuals will voluntarily endorse the 12 principles set forth in the Code, thereby helping us make the Eberly College of Science a place where every individual feels respected and valued, as well as challenged and rewarded.

Educational Equity

Penn State is a community that fosters both a diverse and inclusive environment for the entire campus community. Acts of intolerance, discrimination, or harassment due to age, ancestry, color, disability, gender, gender identity, national origin, race, religious belief, sexual orientation, or veteran status are not tolerated and can be reported through the Educational Equity on the Report Bias webpage: [PSU Report Bias Webpage](#).

Counseling and Psychological Services

Penn State offers a variety of helpful services on campus that support the mental health of students. Counseling and Psychological Services offers such services as group and individual counseling, psychiatric services as well as virtual chats. For more information you can visit the [CAPS](#) website.

Penn State Crisis Line (24 hours/7 days/week): 877-229-6400

Course Coordinators

Nicholas Stepanik and Quinn Minnich

Email: math230coord@psu.edu

Learning Objectives

A complete list of the MATH 230 learning objectives, organized by chapter (Chapters 13–17), is provided in the Official MATH 230 Department Syllabus, which is posted on Canvas.

Important Dates

Event	Date
First Day of Classes	Monday, August 24, 2026
Regular Drop Deadline	Saturday, August 29 at 11:59 p.m.
Regular Add Deadline	Sunday, August 30 at 11:59 p.m.
Labor Day Holiday	Monday, September 7, 2026
*Final Exam Conflict Filing	Monday, September 28 – Sunday, October 25, 2026
*Late Drop Deadline	Friday, November 13 at 11:59 p.m.
Thanksgiving Break	Sunday, November 22 – Saturday, November 28
Classes End	Friday, December 11
*Final Exams	Monday, December 14 – Friday, December 18

Note: The instructor reserves the right to modify this syllabus as the academic term progresses.